띄어쓰기 한눈에 보기: 어디를 붙이고 어디를 띄어요?

A one-page guide to the main Korean spacing rules, with practice on real sentences.

WHAT THIS IS FOR

By the end, you can use a short rule list to decide where to put spaces in everyday Korean sentences.

1 SPACING RULES AT A GLANCE

1. **조사 (이/가, 을/를, 에서, 도, 만)** (particles: write together)
   Write particles right after the word before them, with no space.
   예: 저도 커피만 마셔요.
2. **이다 (-이에요/예요)** ('to be': write together)
   Write 이다 right after the noun, with no space.
   예: 이건 제 거예요.
3. **수** (can, possibility: space)
   In -(으)ㄹ 수 있다/없다, put a space before and after 수.
   예: 한국어로 주문할 수 있어요.
4. **것 (거, 건)** (thing, what: space)
   것 is its own word, even in its short forms 거 and 건.
   예: 제가 좋아하는 건 비빔밥이에요.
5. **지** (time since: space)
   In -(으)ㄴ 지 + a length of time, 지 stands alone.
   예: 서울에 산 지 2년 됐어요.
6. **때** (when, the time: space)
   때 is a noun, so put a space before it.
   예: 시간이 있을 때 연락 주세요.
7. **개, 잔, 명, 달** (counters: space)
   Put a space between a Korean number word and a counter. With digits, you may write them together (2잔).
   예: 아메리카노 두 잔 주세요.
8. **안 / 못** (not, can't: space)
   Write 안 and 못 as separate words before the verb.
   예: 오늘은 술을 못 마셔요.
9. **씨** (Mr./Ms. after a name: space)
   Write 씨 apart from the name.
   예: 지영 씨, 내일 시간 있어요?

2 CHECK YOUR SPACING IN FOUR STEPS

1. **조사·이다 붙이기** (Attach particles and 이다.)
2. **명사 + 하다 붙이기** (Keep noun + 하다 verbs as one word.)
3. **수·것·지·때 띄우기** (Put a space before these small nouns.)
4. **단위·안·못·씨 띄우기** (Put spaces around counters, 안/못, and 씨.)

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3 WHY SPACING MATTERS

Spacing can change the meaning. Koreans often joke about this: 아버지가 방에 들어가신다 (Father goes into the room) vs. 아버지 가방에 들어가신다 (Father goes into the bag).
Watch out: -는지 / -(으)ㄴ지 meaning 'whether' is an ending, so write it together: 어디 가는지 몰라요. 지 meaning 'time since' gets a space: 온 지 1년. In forms, emails, and résumés, correct spacing makes your writing look careful.

These are the standard spacing rules (한글 맞춤법) used in schools, on forms, and in official writing.

4 YOUR TURN

CHECK AND FIX THE SPACING

Use the rule list and the four checking steps to choose, add, or correct the spaces in each sentence.

1. Choose the correctly spaced phrase:
   ①김치를 (못 먹어요 / 못먹어요)
   ②이 우산은 (언니 거예요 / 언니거예요)
   ③사과 (세 개 / 세개) 주세요.
2. Rewrite with correct spacing:
   운전할수있어요?
3. Rewrite with correct spacing:
   한국에온지석달됐어요.
4. Read the message and find the two spacing mistakes. Write the corrected forms:
   수진씨, 내일 회의는 3시 예요. 바쁠 때는 안 와도 돼요.
5. Is the spacing correct? Write O or X:
   ①어제 도서관에서 공부 했어요.
   ②형이 어디 사는지 몰라요.
   ③배가 고플 때 라면을 먹어요.
   ④날씨가 추워서 밖에 안나가요.

✓ ANSWERS

1) ① 못 먹어요 ② 언니 거예요 ③ 세 개
2) 운전할 수 있어요?
3) 한국에 온 지 석 달 됐어요. (세 달 is also correct.)
4) 수진씨 → 수진 씨, 3시 예요 → 3시예요
5) ① X (공부했어요) ② O ③ O ④ X (안 나가요)

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